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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, POST-TYPE, (STORAGE-TYPE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—Loose-leaf, post-type binders covered by this specification are intended for permanent, semi-permanent, and temporary filing.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and classes.*—The binders shall be of the following types and classes, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2):

Type I.—Heavy duty, permanent post.
Type II.—Light duty.
Class 1.—Permanent post.
Class 2.—Semi-permanent post.
Class 3.—Temporary post.

1.2.2 *Sheet sizes, number, length, and center-to-center spacing of posts.*—The binders shall be of the sheet size (first dimension cited shall be the binding edge) and have the number, length, and center-to-center spacing of posts as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2).

1.2.3 *Colors.*—The binders (binding material) shall be blue, green, brown, and maroon, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU-B-536—Board; Binders.
CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-566 — Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Boxes, Fiber.
PPP-B-676 — Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151—Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is

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for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office; Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–B–138—Boxes, Wood, Fiberboard-Lined for Overseas Shipment (for Weight of Contents not Exceeding 500 Pounds).

MIL–B–4229 — Boxes; Paperboard, Metal-Stayed.

MIL–L–10547 — Liners, Case Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of *Military Specifications and Standards* required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publications.** — The following publication forms a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Consolidated Freight Classification Rules.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Consolidated Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Illinois.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Materials.**—Materials shall be of the best quality used in the manufacture of loose-leaf binders, and as specified hereinafter.

3.1.1 *Type I and all classes of type II.*

3.1.1.1 *Binding material.* — Covers and backs shall be bound with Army duck having two-ply yarns in both the warp and filling. The duck shall weigh not less than 7 ounces per square yard.

3.1.1.1.1 *Colorfastness.*—Colorfastness to crocking shall have a rating of at least "fair" when tested in accordance with the test method specified in 4.3.1.1.

3.1.1.1.2 *Breaking strength.*—The canvas shall have a breaking strength of 100 pounds warp and 60 pounds filling with a minus tolerance of 5 percent when tested in accordance with the method specified in 4.3.1.1.

3.1.1.2 *Lining material.*—Paper lining shall be suitable paper having a weight of not less than 70 pounds per 500 sheets, 24 by 36 inches.

3.1.1.3 *Sheet holding bars.* — The sheet holding bars shall be made from steel not less than 0.062 inch thick by 0.50 inch wide.

3.1.1.4 *Locking posts.* — Metal used for locking posts shall have a Rockwell hardness of not less than 65 on the B scale.

3.1.1.5 *End sheets.*—When specified, end sheets shall be suitable paper having a minimum weight of 200 pounds per 500 sheets, 24 by 36 inches, and shall match the lining paper.

3.1.1.6 *Protective treatment.*—All exposed metal posts shall be corrosion resisting or shall have a corrosion-resisting finish and shall not indicate any signs of corrosion when tested as described in 4.3.3.

3.1.2 *Type I.*

3.1.2.1 *Covers.*—Each cover shall be made of sheets or plies of binders board having a total thickness of not less than 0.376 inch. The sheets or plies shall be laminated firmly

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together with adhesives to form a single board. Each sheet of ply of binders board shall conform to the requirements of Federal Specification UU–B–536 for the applicable thickness.

3.1.2.2 *Backs.*—Backs shall be made of binders board not less than 0.095 inch thick, and shall conform to the requirements of Federal Specification UU–B–536.

3.1.2.3 *Hinge.*—Each hinge shall consist of at least three thicknesses of canvas of the quality specified in 3.1.1.1.

3.1.2.4 *Pintle bar housing.*—The pintle bar housing shall be a continuous flat metal housing securely attached to each cover. The housing shall be not less than 0.033-inch-thick cold-rolled steel.

3.1.2.5 *Posts.*—Posts shall be round steel rods, not less than 0.2343 inch in diameter with a plus tolerance of 0.0156 inch.

3.1.3 *Type II, classes 1, 2, and 3.*

3.1.3.1 *Cover and backs.*—Stiff covers and backs shall be made of binders board having a thickness of not less than 0.110 inch conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification UU–B–536. Flexible covers shall be made of double thickness of flexible filler board or shall be a combination of a filler board and a felt paper board, each sheet of which shall be not less than 0.017 inch. Flexible backs shall be a double thickness of canvas of quality specified in 3.1.1.1.

3.1.3.2 *Hinge.*—Each hinge shall consist of at least two thicknesses of canvas as specified in 3.1.1.1.

3.1.3.3 *Locking posts.*—Locking posts shall be made of steel $\frac{7}{16}$ inch in diameter, plus or minus $\frac{1}{64}$ inch.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 *General.*—Each binder shall consist essentially of two covers held together by the locking posts and sheet holding bars. Canvas shall serve as the hinge if backs are required.

3.2.1.1 *Covers.*—Covers at index edge shall be rounded. The binding material shall be carried over the inside face of covers at least $\frac{1}{2}$ inch. The binding material of covers shall be a continuous piece of canvas securely glued in place. The lining material shall overlap edges of canvas at least $\frac{3}{8}$ inch.

3.2.1.2 *Backs.*—Backs, when required, shall be of sufficient width to accommodate posts of the lengths specified.

3.2.2 *Type I.*—Heavy-duty permanent post binders shall consist of two stiff covers hinged to a curved stiff back. A pintle bar housing shall be attached to each cover with slots cut in the housing to receive ends of posts. Pintle bars, operating within the housings, shall hold ends of posts. Two sheet holding bars shall be furnished with each binder. The bars shall be punched or drilled to receive the permanent locking units so the filler sheets can be permanently fastened to the sheet holding bars. The ends of posts shall be punched or drilled to receive the pintle bars and shall be rounded. The lower end of the posts shall be held by a fixed pintle bar. The upper end of the posts shall be held by a sliding pintle bar of the short pull type. When specified, the upper end of posts shall be locked to the metal housing by a cabinet lock operated by a key; one key shall be furnished with each binder.

3.2.3 *Type II, class 1.*—Light-duty permanent binders shall consist of two flexible or stiff covers with flexible, stiff or open backs, as specified. Sheet holding bars shall be attached to and shall be made a part of the covers or shall be hinged to the inside face of covers. The sheet holding bars shall be punched or drilled to accept the locking units which can be permanently fastened.

3.2.4 *Type II, class 2.*—Light-duty semi-permanent post binders shall be constructed the same as type II, class 1 except the lock-

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ing posts shall be of the intra-lock type so that they can be dismantled to insert or remove fillers. One releasing key shall be furnished with each binder.

3.2.5 *Type II, class 3.*—Light-duty temporary post binders shall be constructed the same as type II, class 1 except the locking posts shall be similar or equal to Chicago screw posts.

3.3 **Index tab allowance.** — Binders shall have an index tab allowance of not less than 7/8 inch.

3.4 **End sheets.**—When specified, two end sheets shall be furnished with each binder.

3.5 **Identification marking.**—The following information shall be printed or stamped on the inside of one cover:

Manufacturer's name or trade-mark or both, as applicable.
Property U. S. Government.

3.6 **Workmanship.**—Binders shall be finished in a neat and workmanlike manner. Edges and surfaces shall be smooth and securely fastened. Binders shall be free from all defects and imperfections which affect the appearance or which might impair the serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.

4.1.1 *Size of lot.*—All binders of the same type, class, and size offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of sampling and tests.

4.1.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection.*—From each inspection lot, a random sample of binders shall be taken for Government inspection of visual and dimensional characteristics in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105, Acceptable Quality Level not to exceed 2.5 percent defective.

4.1.3 *Sampling for tests.*—Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, the contractor shall submit samples of the materials, other than metal, which he has used in the manufacture of the binder and a sample of all metal parts which he has used, finished as in the binder. Samples of canvas and binders board shall consist of at least five 10- by 10-inch pieces of canvas and ten 10- by 10-inch pieces of binders board. The lengthwise and crosswise directions of the boards shall be marked on the specimens. When laminated sheets of binders board are used for covers of type I binders, samples of the individual sheets required to make the required total thickness shall be furnished.

4.1.4 *Military Standard MIL–STD–105.*—When Military Standard MIL–STD–105 specifies an action by the Government, it shall at the option of the Government be performed either by the Government or by the contractor under the supervision of the Government inspector.

4.2 **Visual and dimensional inspection.**—Each binder shall be inspected visually for dimensions, identification marking, and workmanship to determine compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Tests.—Sample materials as specified in 4.1.3 shall be tested as specified hereinafter. Failure of the sample to pass any of the tests shall be considered cause for rejection of the entire lot represented by the sample.

4.3.1 *Canvas.*

4.3.1.1 *Colorfastness and breaking strength.*—Canvas shall be tested for colorfastness to crocking and breaking strength (grab method) in accordance with Federal Specification CCC–T–191, methods 5650 and 5100, respectively.

4.3.1.2 *Weight.*—The weight of canvas per square yard shall be determined by weighing the entire sample prior to any other test,

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measuring its area and computing therefrom the weight per square yard.

4.3.2 *Binders board.*—Binders board shall be subjected to the tests specified in Federal Specification UU-B-536.

4.3.3 *Metal parts.*—All exposed metal parts shall be tested for corrosion resistance by placing them in a boiling 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride for a period of 15 minutes. The metal parts, upon being removed from this solution, shall be immediately immersed in 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride at room temperature. They shall then be removed from this solution, and without having the adhering liquid wiped off, allowed to dry for 24 hours at room temperature. The metal parts shall then be rinsed in lukewarm water and allowed to dry.

4.3.4 *Hardness of metals.*—The hardness of metals shall be determined by the Rockwell hardness test, Federal Test Method Standard No. 151.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Federal Standard No. 102.—Levels of packaging and packing protection are defined in Federal Standard No. 102.

5.2 Packaging.—Binders shall be packaged level A or C, as specified in the invitation for bids, contract or order (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.*—Loose-leaf binders shall be individually wrapped in kraft paper or the equivalent and sealed. Locking posts shall be packaged in a kraft envelope and enclosed within the wrap of each binder. Two binders shall be then packaged in a folding paperboard box, set-up box, or metal-stayed paperboard box conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676, and Military Specification MIL-B-4229, respectively. Only one type or class of binder shall be packaged in a unit container.

5.2.2 *Level C.* — Loose-leaf binders and locking posts shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.3 Packing.—Binders, packaged level A or C, shall be packed level A, B or C, as specified in the invitation for bids, contract or order (see 6.2).

5.3.1 *Level A.* — Ten boxes of loose-leaf binders shall be packed in wood-cleated fiberboard, nailed wood, wood wirebound, wood-cleated plywood, fiberboard-lined wood boxes, or fiberboard boxes conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification PPP-B-591 (overseas type), PPP-B-621 (class 2), PPP-B-585 (class 2 or 3), PPP-B-601 (overseas type), Military Specification MIL-B-138, and Federal Specification PPP-B-636, class 2, V3c or V3s, respectively. Boxes shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL-L-10547 (class 2), and sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable box specification. Only one type or class of binder shall be packed in a shipping container.

5.3.2 *Level B.* — Ten boxes of loose-leaf binders shall be packed in style RSC corrugated or solid fiberboard boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP-B-636, type I or II, class 1. All flaps of the box shall be securely sealed with a good-quality adhesive applied throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps. Only one type or class of binder shall be packed in a shipping container.

5.3.3 *Level C.*—Loose-leaf binders shall be packed in a container of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the Consolidated Freight Classification Rules, or regulations of other carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

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5.4 *Marking.*

5.4.1 *Civil agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123, including classification of commodity (type, class, color, etc.).

5.4.2 *Military agencies.* — In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

5.4.2.1 *Nomenclature.*—The item name of material covered by this specification is BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, POST TYPE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.—The binders covered by this specification are intended for use in filing records, reports, and other fillers which are inactive but must be kept for reference.

6.2 Ordering data. — Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein (see 4.1.3, 5.4) and should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Type and class of binder required (see 1.2.1).

(*c*) Sheet size; number, length and center-to-center spacing of posts (see 1.2.1).

(*d*) Color (see 1.2.3).

(*e*) Type of cover and back (see 3.2.3).

(*f*) Whether cabinet lock is required (see 3.2.2).

(*g*) Whether end sheets are required (see 3.4).

(*h*) Both the level of packaging and the level of packing required (see 5.2 and 5.3).

6.3 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired commodity and that normally no sample binders will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects. (See 4.1.3.)

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTEREST:
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Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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